

EF1

MODULE 03

BUSINESS ENGLISH FOR REAL-WORLD APPLICATIONS



EF1

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Lesson 01

Writing Clear and Professional Emails



Warm-Up



Questions:

1. Have you ever received an email that was confusing or unclear? What made it difficult to understand?
2. What do you think makes an email "professional"? Can you give some examples?
3. Why is it important to write clear and professional emails in a business setting?
4. How can you make sure your email is concise yet informative?



Pronunciation

Directions: Practice the pronunciation of the following words.

Words	Pronunciation
1. Subject	/ˈsʌbdʒekt/
2. Recipient	/rɪˈsɪpiənt/
3. Attached	/əˈtætʃt/
4. Minutes	/ˈmɪnɪts/
5. Regards	/rɪˈɡɑrdz/
6. Follow-up	/ˈfəloʊˌʌp/



Sample Email

ANALYZING PROFESSIONAL EMAILS

Directions: Read the sample email and break down the email into its key components. Label and discuss the content of each component.

Subject: Meeting Request to Discuss marketing Strategy

Dear Michael,

I hope you are doing well. I am writing to schedule a meeting to discuss our marketing strategy for the upcoming quarter. It is important for us to align our efforts and ensure we are on the same page.

Could you please let me know your availability next week? I am flexible with the timing and can adjust to fit your schedule.

Looking forward to your response.

Best regards,
Emily Smith

1. Subject Line

- Clearly states the purpose of the email

2. Greeting

- Polite and professional salutation

3. Opening Sentence

- Friendly introduction

4. Body

- Main content of the email, including:
 - **Purpose:** Reason for writing
 - **Details:** Specific information or request

5. Closing Sentence

- Polite closing sentence

6. Sign-Off

- Professional closing followed by a comma.

7. Signature

- Sender's name

Discussion Questions:

1. Why is the subject line important?
2. How does the greeting set the tone for the email?
3. What makes the body of the email effective?
4. How does the closing sentence contribute to the email's professionalism?
5. Why is a proper sign-off and signature essential?



Common Phrases for Professional Emails

1. Formal Ways to Start an Email

- Dear Mr./Ms./Mrs. (Name)
- To Whom It May Concern (*when you do not know the recipient's name.*)

2. Formal Opening/Introduction Sentences for an Email

- I am writing to you regarding/with regards to...
- I am writing to inform you that...
- **(Positive)** I am pleased to...
- **(Negative)** I regret to inform you that..., unfortunately.

3. Formal Ways to Reply to an Email in the Opening Line

- I am writing in reference to your last email.
- I am writing with regards to your previous email.

4. Formal Ways to Inform the Recipient About Attached Files

- Please find the attached documents in this email at your convenience.
- Please refer to the attached documents for further information.
- Attached are the documents for...

5. Formal Ways to Close an Email (Positive Outcome)

- I look forward to seeing you again.
- I look forward to hearing from you soon.
- Best Regards
- Sincerely

6. Formal Ways to Offer Further Communication

- If you need any more information, please do not hesitate to contact me.
- If you need further information, please feel free to contact me.
- If you have any more questions, please do not hesitate to contact me.



Practice

Directions: Analyze the email below by answering the following questions.

Subject: Meeting Follow-Up

Dear Team,

Thank you for attending the meeting yesterday. As discussed, we will proceed with the new marketing strategy. Please find the attached meeting minutes for your reference.

Best Regards,
John Brown

Questions:

1. What elements make this email clear and professional?
2. How does the subject line help the recipient understand the purpose of the email?
3. What could be added to ensure all necessary information is included?
4. What are some polite ways to follow up on an email?
5. What are some common mistakes people make when writing professional emails?



Production

EMAIL WRITING EXERCISE

Directions: Write an email based on the given scenario. Exchange emails with your partner. Analyze your partner's email and then provide feedback by using the guidelines below.

Scenario: Change in Work Schedule

Your manager asked you to inform your team that the work schedule will change starting next Monday. Everyone will start 30 minutes earlier than usual.

Task: Write an email to your team explaining the new schedule and the reason for the change.

Context and Guidance:

- Clearly state the effective date of the schedule change.
- Specify the new start time.
- Include a brief explanation for the change (e.g., the reason for adjusting the schedule).
- Use a polite and professional tone throughout the email.
- Encourage team members to reach out with any questions or concerns.

Feedback Guidelines:

- 1. Clarity:** Is the email easy to understand? Are the purpose and details of the meeting clearly stated?
- 2. Professionalism:** Is the tone appropriate? Does the email follow proper etiquette and format?
- 3. Suggestions:** Provide constructive feedback on how email can improve.

Lesson 02

Writing Weekly and Monthly Reports



Warm-Up

**Questions:**

1. What types of reports have you had to write in the past (if any)?
2. How often do you think reports should be written in a workplace environment?
3. What information do you think is important to include in a report?
4. What challenges do you face when writing reports?
5. Why is it important to write clear and concise reports in a business setting?
6. How do you ensure your reports are understood by all?



Sample Analysis

Directions: Study the target phrases in the column and distinguish how they are different.

UNCLEAR REPORT	CLEAR REPORT
The findings of the monthly meeting says many people are availing sick leave in the office because of the virus in the workplace.	The monthly report released this end month of March found that 5% of employees used their Sick Leave benefit because of the proliferation of Flu Virus in the Productions Department.
Operations Manager Ted who is new to the job this year mentioned we are all lucky in the company that we have this job still because of recession.	Another fact mentioned during the Monthly meeting came from its Operations Manager – Mr. Todd Philips who was happy that the current job provides opportunity despite the recession.
One department is said to be terminated because of poor production performance that was said to be occurring for longer times now.	Employees are encouraged to give their best in the workplace because as recession happens, thus the company would want its best not to terminate anybody.



Reports Structure and Common Phrases

CONTENT		DESCRIPTION	PHRASES
Title		Clearly state that it's a weekly or monthly report.	<i>"Weekly/Monthly Report: [Project Name/Team Name]"</i>
Date		Include the date range covered.	<i>"Date Range: [Start Date] to [End Date]"</i> <i>"Reporting Period: [Start Date] - [End Date]"</i>
Introduction		Briefly state the purpose of the report.	<i>"This report aims to..."</i> <i>"The purpose of this report is to..."</i>
Main Body	Achievements	Highlight key accomplishments.	<i>"During this period, we have successfully achieved..."</i>
	Current progress	Describe ongoing tasks or projects.	<i>"Currently, we are working on..."</i>
	Challenges	Discuss any challenges faced.	<i>"There were several obstacles faced, including..."</i>
	Solutions	Explain the actions taken to overcome a challenge or problem.	<i>"To address this, we..."</i>
	Next Steps	Outline what's planned for the upcoming week/month.	<i>"Next, we plan to..."</i> <i>"Our priority for the coming week is..."</i>
Conclusion		Summarize the overall progress.	<i>"To conclude, the project is on track with..."</i>
Signature		Include your name and position if applicable.	<i>"Best regards,"</i> <i>"Thank you,"</i> <i>"Sincerely,"</i>



Practice

Directions: Analyze the weekly report below and answer the following questions.

Subject: Weekly Report (April 7-12, 2025)

Dear Team,

This week, we achieved the following milestones:

- Completed the initial phase of the marketing campaign.
- Held a successful client meeting with XYZ Corporation.
- Resolved 95% of customer support tickets within 24 hours.

Next week, we plan to:

- Launch the second phase of the marketing campaign.
- Conduct a training session for the sales team.
- Improve response time for customer support tickets.

Best regards,

Kevin Arnolds

Planning Team 1 Manager

Questions:

1. What elements make this report clear and effective?
2. What could be added to ensure all necessary information is included?
3. What are some common mistakes to avoid when writing business reports?
4. How can you make sure your report is straightforward yet informative?
5. What are some strategies to ensure your report is visually appealing and easy to read?



Production

REPORT WRITING EXERCISE

Directions: Write a weekly or monthly report based on the given scenarios below. Exchange reports and provide feedback on clarity and effectiveness.

1. Choose a type of report

- Project progress report
- Sales performance report
- Marketing campaign update
- Financial summary

2. Report Writing

- Each participant writes a report based on their chosen scenario.
- Don't forget to incorporate these parts in your report.
 - **Title:** Clearly state the report's purpose.
 - **Introduction:** Brief overview of the report's content.
 - **Body:** Detailed information, including data, analysis, and key points.
 - **Conclusion:** Summary of findings and recommendations.
 - **Appendices** (if applicable): Additional data or supporting documents.

3. Report Presentation and Feedback Review:

- Present your written report in the class.
- Afterwards, exchange your reports for peer review. Use these guidelines for your feedback review. Use constructive and specific feedback.

Feedback Guidelines:

- **Clarity:** Is the report easy to understand? Are the key points clearly stated?
- **Effectiveness:** Does the report achieve its purpose? Are the recommendations actionable?
- **Structure:** Is the report well-organized? Are the sections logically arranged?
- **Professionalism:** Is the tone appropriate? Are there any grammatical or formatting errors?

Lesson 3

Writing Requests and Apologies



Warm-Up

Motivation Questions:

- Why is it important to write clear and polite requests in a business setting?
- Can you think of a situation where a well-written apology made a difference in a business relationship?
- How do you ensure your requests and apologies are understood and accepted by the recipient?





Sample Request and Apology Emails

Study the following sample emails

Subject: Request for Information

Dear John,

I hope this message finds you well. I am writing to request information regarding the upcoming project deadlines. Could you please provide the updated timeline at your earliest convenience?

Thank you for your assistance.

Best regards,

Anne Smith

Subject: Apology for Missed Deadline

Dear Anne,

I am writing to sincerely apologize for missing the project deadline. Due to unforeseen circumstances, we were unable to complete the task on time. We understand the inconvenience this has caused and are taking steps to ensure it does not happen again.

Thank you for your understanding.

Best regards,

John Dee

Analysis Questions:

- What elements make these emails clear and effective?
- How does the structure help the recipient understand the purpose of the email?
- What could be added to ensure all necessary information is included?

Discussion

- What are some common mistakes to avoid when writing requests and apologies?
- How can you make sure your request is polite yet assertive?
- What are some strategies to ensure your apology is sincere and accepted?



Common Phrases

KEY PHRASES FOR WRITING REQUESTS

Contents	Phrases
Opening Statements	• <i>"I hope this email finds you well."</i> • <i>"I am writing to request your assistance with..."</i> • <i>"I would like to ask for your help regarding..."</i>
Making the Request	• <i>"Could you please...?"</i> • <i>"Would it be possible for you to...?"</i> • <i>"I would appreciate it if you could..."</i>
Providing Context	• <i>"This request is important because..."</i> • <i>"Due to the upcoming deadline..."</i> • <i>"I would like to ensure that... by [specific date]."</i>
Closing Statements	• <i>"Thank you for considering my request."</i> • <i>"Please let me know if you need any further information."</i> • <i>"I look forward to your response."</i>

KEY PHRASES FOR WRITING APOLOGY EMAILS

Contents	Phrases
Opening Statements	• <i>"I hope this email finds you well."</i> • <i>"I am writing to sincerely apologize for..."</i>
Acknowledging the Issue	• <i>"I apologize for any inconvenience this may have caused."</i> • <i>"I acknowledge that this situation may have affected you."</i>
Taking Responsibility	• <i>"Full responsibility for the situation has been acknowledged."</i> • <i>"I am committed to making things right and learning from this experience."</i>
Offering an Explanation (if appropriate)	• <i>"The reason for this was..."</i> • <i>"Unfortunately, this occurred due to..."</i>
Proposing a Solution	• <i>"To rectify this situation, I will..."</i> • <i>"I am taking steps to ensure this does not happen again by..."</i> • <i>"I would like to offer [compensation or solution]."</i>
Closing Statements	• <i>"Thank you for your understanding and patience."</i> • <i>"Please let me know if there's anything else I can do to resolve this matter."</i>



Practice

Polite Language Transformation Drill

1. **Work individually or in pairs** to rewrite the sentences below in a more polite, professional way, using the target phrases from the lesson, such as:

- Would you mind...
- Could you possibly...
- I'd appreciate it if you could...
- I'm sorry for...
- I apologize for...
- Please accept my apologies for...

2. **Sentences**

- a. Request: "Give me an update tomorrow."
- b. Request: "Call me back now."
- c. Request: "Tell me if you can't come."
- d. Apology: "I forgot the meeting."
- e. Apology: "I was late."
- f. Apology: "I didn't reply to your email."



Production

WRITING EFFECTIVE REQUESTS AND APOLOGY

Instructions:

1. Scenario Assignment: Receive a scenario

Request	Apology
A. Requesting a meeting with a colleague. B. Asking for additional resources for a project. C. Requesting feedback on a recent presentation. D. Asking a team member for assistance on a task. E. Requesting time off for a personal matter.	A. Apologizing for a missed deadline. B. Apologizing for a scheduling conflict. C. Apologizing for a delay in response to an email. D. Apologizing for missing a team meeting. E. Apologizing for providing incorrect information in a previous communication.

2. Writing Emails: Write an email based on your scenario, including:

Request	Apology
• Greeting: Polite salutation • Purpose: Clear statement of the request • Details: Specific information needed • Politeness: Courteous language • Closing: Professional sign-off	• Greeting: Polite salutation • Acknowledgment: Recognition of the issue • Responsibility: Taking responsibility for the mistake • Remedy: Offering a solution or remedy • Closing: Professional sign-off

3. **Exchange Requests:** Swap your emails with a partner and use feedback forms to assess clarity and politeness.
4. **Feedback Review:** Review your partner's request and provide feedback on:
 - **Clarity:** Is the request easy to understand?
 - **Politeness:** Is the tone courteous and professional?
 - **Specificity:** Are the details of the request clear and specific?
5. **Discussion:** Share experiences and insights with the group, focusing on strengths and improvements.

Assessment Criteria

For Requests

Criteria	Yes	Somewhat	No	Comments/Suggestions
Clear greeting				
Clear purpose				
Specific details				
Polite tone				
Professional closing				

For Apologies

Criteria	Yes	Somewhat	No	Comments/Suggestions
Clear greeting				
Acknowledgement of issue				
Responsibility taken				
Remedy/solution offered				
Polite, professional closing				

Lesson 04

Writing for Business Meetings

 Warm-Up**Motivation Questions:**

- What types of documents do you typically write for business meetings?
- Why is it important to write clear and concise documents for business meetings?
- Can you think of a meeting that was particularly effective or ineffective due to the quality of its written documents?
- How do you ensure your meeting documents are understood by all participants?





Sample Analysis

Study the following samples

Subject: Agenda for Team Meeting – April 7, 2025

Dear Team,

Please find below the agenda for our upcoming meeting:

1. Welcome and Introductions - John Green
2. Review of Previous Meeting Minutes - Alice Smith
3. Project Updates - Michael Johnson
4. Discussion on New Marketing Strategy - Emily Davis
5. Q&A Session - David Lee
6. Next Steps and Action Items - Sarah Brown

Best regards,

John Green

Subject: Minutes of Team Meeting – April 8 Dear Team,

Below are the minutes from our meeting held on April 7:

1. Welcome and Introductions - John Green
 - All members were present.
2. Review of Previous Meeting Minutes - Alice Smith
 - Minutes were approved without changes.
3. Project Updates - Michael Johnson
 - Project A is on track.
 - Project B requires additional resources.
4. Discussion on New Marketing Strategy - Emily Davis
 - Agreed to implement the new strategy starting next month.
5. Q&A Session - David Lee
 - Addressed questions regarding project timelines.
6. Next Steps and Action Items - Sarah Brown
 - Michael Johnson to follow up on resource allocation for Project B.
 - Emily Davis to prepare a detailed plan for the new marketing strategy.

Best regards,

CEO

Subject: Follow-Up on Team Meeting – April 9

Dear Team,

Thank you for attending the meeting on April 7. As discussed, please find attached the minutes of the meeting. Kindly review the action items and update your progress by the end of the week.

Best regards,

CEO

Analysis Questions:

- What elements make these documents clear and effective?
- How does the structure help the recipient understand the key points?
- What could be added to ensure all necessary information is included?

Discussion

- What are some common mistakes to avoid when writing business meeting documents?
- How can you make sure your agenda is concise yet informative?
- What are some strategies to ensure your minutes are accurate and comprehensive?
- What are the key elements that make a good meeting agenda?
- Why is it important to have clear and concise meeting minutes?
- How can follow-up emails enhance understanding after a meeting?



Vocabulary: Business Meeting Documents

Common components of Business Meeting Documents and key phrases

CONTENTS	COMPONENTS	KEY PHRASES
Meeting Agenda	- Title of the meeting - Date, time, and location - List of topics - Assigned speakers or facilitators	• <i>"The agenda for this meeting includes..."</i> • <i>"We will discuss the following topics..."</i>
Meeting Minutes	- Title with date - List of attendees - Summary of discussions - Action items and responsible parties	• <i>"The meeting commenced at [Time]."</i> • <i>"Key decisions made include..."</i> • <i>"Action items are as follows..."</i>
Follow-Up Email	- Reference to the meeting - Summary of discussion points - List of action items - Deadline reminders	• <i>"Thank you for attending the meeting on [Date]."</i> • <i>"Here are the key takeaways from our discussion..."</i>



Practice

QUIZ: Choose the correct answer

1. What is the purpose of a meeting agenda?

- a) To summarize the past meetings
- b) To outline topics for discussion in an upcoming meeting
- c) To review team performance
- d) To provide feedback

2. Who is responsible for taking minutes during a meeting?

- a) The project manager
- b) Any attendee who volunteers
- c) The facilitator of the meeting
- d) The team leader only

3. Which of the following should NOT be included in meeting minutes?

- a) The date and time of the meeting
- b) A detailed description of all discussions
- c) Personal opinions about attendees
- d) Action items and responsible parties

4. True or False: Action items in meeting minutes should include deadlines.

- a) True
- b) False

5. What is the correct salutation to use in a follow-up email after a meeting?

- a) "Hi everyone,"
- b) "Dear Team,"
- c) "To whom it may concern,"
- d) "Hey,"

6. A key phrase to use when summarizing decisions made in a meeting is:

- a) "In conclusion..."
- b) "I think that..."
- c) "It's important to note..."
- d) "Everyone should remember..."



Production

DOCUMENT WRITING EXERCISE

1. Work in pairs or small groups

2. Choose Your Document Type

- Meeting Agenda
- Meeting Minutes
- Follow-Up Email

3. Scenario Presentation

Choose one of the following scenarios:

- **Scenario 1:** A project update meeting for a software development team.
- **Scenario 2:** A budget review meeting with the finance department.
- **Scenario 3:** A strategy planning session for a new marketing campaign.

4. Writing Your Document

For Meeting Agenda:

- Title: "Agenda for [Document Type] – [Date]"
- Include date, time, and location.
- List at least 3 agenda items and their speakers.

For Meeting Minutes:

- Title: "Minutes of [Document Type] – [Date]"
- Include date, time, and attendees.
- Summarize discussions for at least 2 agenda items and 2 action items with responsible parties.

For Follow-Up Email:

- Subject Line: "Follow-Up on [Meeting Type] – [Date]"
- Thank the participants.
- Briefly summarize key points and action items with deadlines.
- Friendly closing.

5. Exchange and Review: Once the documents are written, present your document with to the class.

6. Feedback Session: Review each other's documents and provide constructive feedback on aspects such as clarity, structure, and effectiveness. Make sure your feedback is specific and actionable.



Key Vocabulary

Target Phrases	Use	Example
<i>Review of last meeting's action items</i>	To revisit and assess the tasks or decisions made in the previous meeting.	<i>Let's start with a review of last meeting's action items to ensure everything is on track.</i>
<i>Discussion on project deadlines</i>	To talk about and set timelines for project milestones and deliverables.	<i>Next, we will have a discussion on project deadlines to finalize our schedule.</i>
<i>The key takeaway is...</i>	To highlight the most important point or lesson from a discussion or presentation.	<i>The key takeaway is that we need to improve our customer service to increase satisfaction.</i>
<i>Action items assigned to...</i>	To specify the tasks and responsibilities given to team members.	<i>Action items assigned to John include drafting the proposal and coordinating with the marketing team.</i>
<i>To summarize, we agreed on...</i>	To recap the main decisions or agreements made during a meeting.	<i>To summarize, we agreed on the new project timeline and budget allocations.</i>
<i>The next steps include...</i>	To outline the actions that will follow a discussion or meeting.	<i>The next steps include finalizing the budget and scheduling a meeting with the stakeholders.</i>

Lesson 05

Review 01: Lessons 01- 04



Warm-Up

Read each question and choose the correct answer.

1. What is the ideal length of a professional email subject line?

- A) 3-5 words
- B) 10-15 words
- C) One full sentence

2. Which of the following is a polite way to request a deadline extension?

- A) "I need more time."
- B) "Could you please extend the deadline?"
- C) "I can't finish on time."

3. True or False: Informal phrases like "Hey" or "Thanks a lot" are always acceptable in business emails.

- A) True
- B) False

4. What is a key part of writing a weekly report?

- A) Sharing personal goals
- B) Including completed tasks and next steps
- C) Adding emotional commentary

5. Which of the following should be included in meeting notes?

- A) Small talk
- B) Action items and decisions made
- C) Background history of the project



Practice

Activity 1: Re-write an Email

Directions: Read the informal email below. Work in pairs or small groups and rewrite the email using an appropriate subject line, greeting, polite tone, and a clear closing.

Subject: [Blank]

Hey,

Can you send me that report from last week? Also, we need to talk about the meeting. I'm super busy today, so make it quick.

Activity 2: Organize the Report

Directions: Below is a draft of a poorly written weekly report. Work in pairs or small groups and revise it to be clear, organized, and professional.

Fix it by organizing it into these sections:

1. Progress
2. Challenges
3. Next Steps

Original Report Excerpt

Hi. So yeah, we did some stuff. John worked on the slides and I think we'll finish soon. I'm not sure what's going on with the budget, but we might be out. Next, maybe we'll plan a meeting?



Production

Choose one of the contexts and write a professional report/ email (100 – 250 words).
Exchange your reports/ emails and provide feedback if necessary:

Context:

1. A customer ordered office supplies from your company. The order was supposed to arrive in 3 days, but it arrived 7 days later. The customer sent an email expressing their frustration.

Write a formal reply email to the customer. The email should:

- Apologize for the delay.
- Explain the reason for the delay (e.g., supply issue, transport problem).
- Offer a solution or compensation (e.g., discount, free shipping on next order).

2. You are part of a team developing a mobile app for a client. The project started two weeks ago and is scheduled to finish in six weeks.

Write a professional report following the structure:

- Introduction: A brief overview of the project and timeline.
- Progress: Tasks completed so far.
- Challenges: Any issues or delays.
- Next Steps: What's planned for the coming week.

Feedback Guidelines:

- **Clarity:** Is the writing easy to understand? Are the key points clearly stated?
- **Effectiveness:** Does the writing achieve its purpose? Are the recommendations actionable?
- **Structure:** Is the writing well-organized? Are the sections logically arranged?
- **Professionalism:** Is the tone appropriate? Are there any grammatical or formatting errors?

Discussion:

1. What was the most challenging part of writing collaboratively?
2. What part of your report are you most confident about?
3. What would you improve if you had more time?
4. How can you apply this structure to real workplace reports?

Lesson 06

Interview Introduction



Warm-up

Introduction Topics

Instruction: Look at the list of topics below, decide what topics should be included in an interview introduction.

1. Greeting & politeness
2. Hobbies & personal interests
3. Your full name
4. Current position / job title
5. Department/team
6. Your key responsibilities
7. Current project / work focus
8. Years at the company / background (optional)
9. Family details
10. Achievements relevant to customer/project (optional)
11. How your work benefits the customer
12. Salary and benefits
13. Detailed technical jargon
14. Closing statement / transition



Role-play

Interviewer: Good afternoon, and thank you for joining the interview today.

Candidate: Good afternoon. Thank you for having me.

Interviewer: To begin, could you please introduce yourself?

Candidate: Of course. My name is Mai Nguyen, and I'm a customer support specialist with **three years of experience** in the Customer Care Department.

Currently, I'm working on the Client Support Improvement Project, where we focus on reducing response time and improving customer satisfaction.

I'm also responsible for handling technical tickets, guiding customers through troubleshooting steps, and reporting common product issues to the product development team.

That's a short introduction about me.

Interviewer: Thank you, Mai. That's a very clear overview. Let's continue with some questions about your experience.

Role-play Analysis

1. How does the candidate greet the interviewer?
2. What information does the candidate give about their name and current position?
3. How does the candidate describe their experience and responsibilities?
4. What project or focus area does the candidate mention?
5. How does the candidate close their introduction and transition back to the interviewer?



Introduction Structure

1. Greetings
2. Name
3. Position/Department & Experience
4. Project / Focus / Responsibilities
5. Closing / Transition



Position and Experience

Content	Phrases
Position	• “I am a <i>[Job Title]</i> at <i>[Company Name]</i>.” • “I work as a <i>[Job Title]</i> at <i>[Company Name]</i>.”
Department	• “I’m in / part of the <i>[Department Name]</i>, focusing on <i>[area of work]</i>.”
Years of Work	• “I’ve been with <i>[Company Name]</i> for <i>[X years/months]</i>.” • “I joined <i>[Company Name]</i> in <i>[year]</i>.”
Experience	• “I have <i>[number]</i> experience in <i>[field]</i>.”



Responsibility

Content	Phrases
Project name/type	“Currently, I’m working on [project].”
Goal or purpose	“The goal of this project is to [goal].”
Your responsibilities	“I am responsible for + N/V_ing” “I am in charge of + N/V+ing.”
Your main tasks	“I help to [task 1] and [task 2]...”



Closing and Transition

- That’s a little about me.
- I’m happy to answer any questions you have.



Practice

INTRODUCE YOURSELF IN AN INTERVIEW

- Pair up with a partner.
- One person will be the interviewer, and the other will be the candidate.
- Use the provided key phrases and questions to conduct a mock job interview in INTRODUCTION. Switch roles to practice both interviewer and candidate.
- After the role-play, discuss how each of you did. What went well, and what can be improved?



Production

To understand more about the introduction in an interview, answer the following questions.

1. How long should an introduction be?
2. Why is a clear introduction important in a customer interview or professional meeting?
3. How do you normally describe your current project or tasks in English?
4. What phrases do you find easy or difficult to use?
5. What challenges do you face when explaining your responsibilities in English?
6. How do you make a good first impression when meeting a customer or colleague online?
7. Which phrases from today's lesson do you think are most useful for you? Why?
8. What differences do you notice between introductions in Vietnamese workplaces and international workplaces?

Lesson 07

Talking about Work Experience



Warm-up

Two truths and a Lie

Instruction: Think of **three short sentences** about your past work experience. Two are true, and one is false. Share with your partner/group. Others must guess which one is the lie. Example:

- *I used to work as a sales assistant.*
- *I was responsible for training new staff.*
- *I gained experience in designing mobile apps.*



Case Study

Scenario: Emma shares her work experience in an online interview

Role-Play Dialogue

Interviewer: Hi Emma, could you share one IT project you are proud of?

Emma: Sure. I worked as a software developer in a banking project. My main task was to develop a tool to automate daily transaction reports. It was very important because the reports were taking too much time before.

Interviewer: Interesting. What challenges did you face?

Emma: At the beginning, the data was inconsistent and the tool often crashed. I spent time debugging and also collaborated with a senior teammate to solve these issues.

Interviewer: How did you finally manage it?

Emma: We improved the code structure and tested it with real banking data. After several rounds, the tool became stable.

Interviewer: What was the outcome?

Emma: The reporting time was reduced from 3 hours to only 10 minutes. The managers

were very happy, and the tool is still used in the bank today.

Interviewer: Great. What did you learn from this experience?

Emma: I learned that teamwork and problem-solving are essential in IT projects. I also improved my technical skills in debugging and automation.

Role-Play Analysis

1. Why do you think Emma chose this project as her example in the interview?
2. How did Emma's way of explaining the challenge make her story clear and engaging?
3. What does the project outcome tell you about Emma's impact on the company?
4. If you were the interviewer, what deeper follow-up question would you ask Emma?
5. In what way could Emma improve her storytelling to sound more convincing or impressive?



Grammar

Tense	Use	Example
Past Simple	Used for specific past events (finished, with a time reference).	<i>I joined this company in 2020.</i>
Present Perfect	Used for life experiences or unfinished actions (no specific time).	<i>I have worked in marketing for five years.</i>



Vocabulary: Work Experience Storytelling

When talking about your past work experience, you can use the **CAR Method** to make your story clear and professional.

CAR = Context - Action - Result

STEPS	PURPOSE	PHRASES
C – Context	Briefly set the scene and explain why the process/project mattered.	• <i>In my previous project, ...</i> • <i>One time, I worked on...</i> • <i>At [company], we needed to ...</i> • <i>A challenge I faced was ...</i>
A – Action	Show your process, tools used, and your decisions.	• <i>I started by ..., then ...</i> • <i>I implemented ... using ...</i> • <i>We decided to ... because ...</i> • <i>During the process, I ...</i>
R – Result	End with a concise benefit, improvement, or lesson learned.	• <i>As a result, ...</i> • <i>We achieved ...</i> • <i>This project helped me develop...</i> • <i>I learned a lot about...</i>

Example Mini Story (using CAR):

Context: *Last year I worked on a software project with only two weeks to finish. My job was to design the user interface.*

Action: *I worked extra hours and used design templates to save time.*

Result: *We finished on time and the client was satisfied.*



Practice

1. Complete the sentences with Past Simple or Present Perfect:

- a. I _____ (travel) to Germany last year.
- b. She _____ (never/work) in a multinational company.
- c. We _____ (meet) the new manager yesterday.
- d. He _____ (already/finish) the report.
- e. They _____ (start) the project two months ago.
- f. I _____ (know) my colleague since 2018.
- g. She _____ (attend) the conference last week.
- h. The company _____ (grow) a lot in the past five years.
- i. We _____ (not/receive) the email yet.
- j. When _____ you _____ (join) this company?

2. Words to Story

Instruction:

- Students get a clue card
- In breakout rooms (pairs/small groups), make a **2–3 sentence story** related to the clue card
- Try to use target phrases (e.g., I was responsible for..., It was challenging because..., Finally we...).
- After that, students will be invited to share in the main room.

Card 1	Card 2
Project deadline – teamwork – celebrate	Difficult client – problem solving – success
Card 3	Card 4
New technology – training – improvement	Unexpected mistake – quick action – lesson learned

Example: Project deadline – teamwork – celebrate

“I was responsible for finishing a project with my team. It was challenging because the deadline was very short, but we worked together and finally we celebrated our success.”



Production

WORK EXPERIENCE THEATER

Instruction: In pairs, use the CAR model to act out the following scenarios. Focus on clearly and concisely describing your work experiences.

Scenario 1: Sharing work stories with a colleague

Student A: You and Student B are colleagues on a break. Ask Student B about a memorable project they worked on.

Student B: Describe a memorable project, explaining your role and what you learned.

Scenario 2: Networking Event

Student A: You are at a networking event. Introduce yourself to Student B and ask about their most recent professional accomplishment.

Student B: Introduce yourself and describe your most recent professional accomplishment, highlighting the skills you used.

Discussion

1. Which part of telling a work-experience story is easiest for you: Context, Action, or Result? Why?
2. What challenges do you still have when talking about past projects in English?
3. Which new phrases from today's lesson do you think you will use in real interviews or meetings?
4. How did the CAR method help you make your story clearer or more professional?

Lesson 08

Talking about Strengths



Role-play

Interviewer: Good morning! Thank you for coming in today. Can you start by telling me a little about yourself?

Candidate: Good morning! My name is Maria. I have a degree in marketing, and I have worked for two years at a marketing agency. I enjoy creating social media campaigns.

Interviewer: What skills do you possess, and what is your current role?

Candidate: ***My skills include*** strong communication and organization. ***I currently work as*** an office assistant at Bright Solutions, where I help manage daily tasks and support the team with various projects.

Interviewer: That sounds interesting! What do you believe is your greatest strength?

Candidate: ***I think my greatest strength is*** my creativity. I have many ideas and I enjoy finding new ways to solve problems.

Interviewer: That's great to hear! Can you give me an example of when you used your creativity at work?

Candidate: Sure! At my last job, I created a campaign that increased our social media engagement by 30%. I used different visuals and fun content to attract people.

Interviewer: Impressive! What would you say is a challenge you have faced because of your strength?

Candidate: Sometimes my creativity makes me take longer to finish tasks because I want everything to be perfect. I am learning to balance my ideas with deadlines.

Interviewer: Thank you for sharing that. Do you have any questions for me?

Candidate: Yes! What is the biggest challenge the team is currently facing?

Role-play Analysis

1. What is the candidate's greatest strength?
2. How did the candidate give an example of their strength?
3. What challenge does the candidate mention regarding their strength?



Useful Phrases

Contents	Key phrases
Talking about Strengths	• <i>"I believe my greatest strength is..."</i> • <i>"I am very skilled at..."</i> • <i>"My colleagues often say that I am..."</i>
Giving Examples of Your Strength	• <i>"For example, in my last job, I..."</i> • <i>"I used this strength when I..."</i> • <i>"This strength helped me to..."</i>



Useful Tips

1. Be Honest and Focused	Choose 1–2 strengths that are most relevant to the job (for example, communication, problem-solving, patience).
2. Give Simple Examples	Support each strength with a short example from your experience. <i>"I am good at listening to customers. For example, in my last job, I always asked questions to understand their needs."</i>

3. Use Positive and Clear Language	Use phrases like “I am good at...”, “I am skilled at...”, “I enjoy...”, or “I have experience in...”
4. Show How Your Strengths Help Customers	Explain briefly how your strength benefits the customer or company. <i>“I am patient, so I can help customers who are confused or upset.”</i>
5. Be Confident, Not Arrogant	Speak with confidence, but do not exaggerate. <i>“I believe my communication skills help me solve problems quickly.”</i>
6. Stay Professional and Polite	Use formal or semi-formal language. Avoid slang.



Practice

Fill in blanks: Fill each blank with the correct word or phrase from the list

- a. qualifications
- b. strengths
- c. weaknesses
- d. career
- e. employer
- f. My skills include...
- g. I'm eager to contribute to...
- h. Could you tell me more about the role
- i. My greatest strength is...

1. It's okay to talk about one or two _____ you are working to improve.
2. _____ and the main tasks I would do each day?
3. _____ my ability to stay calm and solve problems under pressure.
4. Before the interview, please bring your original _____ and a copy of your CV.
5. My previous _____ offered paid training during the first month.
6. _____ customer service, data entry, and good telephone skills.
7. What are your main _____ for this position?
8. _____ the team by taking on administrative tasks and helping new staff.
9. She plans to change her _____ from sales to marketing next year.

B. Match the Strengths to the Examples

Strengths	Examples
1. Creativity	a. "I organized team meetings to understand everyone's ideas and improve our projects."
2. Communication	b. "I developed a unique product concept that boosted sales by 25% in three months."
3. Time Management	c. "I always finish my tasks ahead of schedule, allowing me to help others."
4. Problem-Solving	d. "When issues arise, I quickly assess the situation and find a solution for the team."
5. Teamwork	e. "I adapted to remote work easily during the pandemic and kept my productivity high."
6. Adaptability	f. "I take the time to check my work for errors, ensuring everything is correct."
7. Leadership	g. "I led a project where I motivated my team and achieved our goals successfully."
8. Attention to Detail	h. "I explain complex information clearly, making it easy for anyone to understand."



Production

TALK ABOUT YOUR STRENGTHS

- In pairs, decide roles (A = Candidate, B = Interviewer).
- Candidate: choose 2-3 strengths from your CV and prepare one short example for each (one or two sentences).
- Interview: asks questions from the prompt list below. Candidate answers, using at least two key phrases. Interviewer takes brief notes.
- Feedback: Interviewer gives one positive comment and one suggestion for improvement.
- Swap roles and repeat.

Interviewer prompts (use at least 5):

- *Tell me about yourself and the skills you possess.*
- *What are your main strengths? Can you give an example?*
- *How will your strengths help you in this job?*
- *Can you tell me about a time when you used [strength] at work?*
- *Why do you want this job?*
- *Do you have any questions for me?*

Key phrases for candidates:

- *"My skills include..."*
- *"My greatest strength is..." / "One of my strengths is..."*
- *"Being... means I can..."*
- *"For example, at my last job I..."*
- *"I'm eager to contribute to..."*
- *"Could you tell me more about the role?" / "What does a typical day look like?"*



Key Vocabulary

Key Phrases	Use	Example
Arrogant	Showing too much pride in yourself; thinking you are better than others	<i>He sounded arrogant when he said he was the best employee.</i>
Eager	Very interested and excited to do something	<i>She is eager to learn new skills and help customers.</i>
Exaggerate	To make something seem bigger, better, or worse than it really is	<i>He tends to exaggerate his achievements in interviews.</i>

Lesson 09

Mock Job Interview



Warm-up

Answer the following questions:

1. Think about a time you really wanted something – a job, a promotion, or even a place on a training course. What did you do to convince the person in charge to choose you?
2. In a world where many people have similar qualifications, what makes one candidate stand out from another in a job interview?



Role-play

Interviewer: Good morning! Thank you for coming in today. Can you please introduce yourself?

Candidate: Good morning! My name is Maria, and I have a degree in marketing. I have worked for two years in a marketing agency, where I learned to create effective social media campaigns.

Interviewer: That sounds interesting! What do you consider your greatest strength?

Candidate: I believe my greatest strength is my creativity. I enjoy brainstorming new ideas and finding innovative solutions to problems. My colleagues often say that I am very skilled at coming up with unique strategies.

Interviewer: Great to hear! And what would you say is a **weakness** of yours?

Candidate: ***One area I am working to improve is*** that I sometimes take on too much work because I want to help everyone. I know I need to set limits and focus on my priorities.

Interviewer: Thank you for your honesty. What are your salary expectations?

Candidate: I would like a salary between \$28,000 and \$32,000 per year. ***I am open to discussing this*** and I would like to know about benefits and training.

Interviewer: Do you have any questions for me about the role or the company?

Candidate: Yes. Can you tell me about the team I would work with? Also, what are the next steps in the recruitment process?

Interviewer: We have a small team of five people. The next step is a second interview next week. Thank you, Maria.

Candidate: Thank you. I look forward to hearing from you.

Role-play Analysis

1. Where did Maria work before?
2. How does Maria explain her weakness?
3. What salary range does Maria give?
4. What two questions does Maria ask the interviewer?



Interview Tips

Tips for a Job Interview:

1. **Be punctual:** Demonstrate your commitment to timelines. ("I am punctual.")
2. **Offer a warm greeting:** Establish rapport with professional courtesy. ("Hello, good morning/afternoon.")
3. **Communicate clearly:** Articulate your responses with precision. ("I possess the ability to...", "My expertise includes...")
4. **Highlight your qualifications:** Emphasize your relevant skills and experience. ("I am proficient in...", "I have a proven track record in...")
5. **Express a positive demeanor:** Convey your enthusiasm and motivation. ("I am highly interested in this opportunity," "I am a dedicated professional.")

Asking Questions & Discussing Salary:

1. **Be Relevant:** Ask questions about the *role, team, or company*.
2. **Show Interest:** Frame questions to demonstrate your *potential contribution*.
3. **Be Professional:** Use clear, concise language and a respectful tone.
4. **Salary Expectations:** Research industry standards and *provide a salary range*.



Key Phrases

Contents	Key phrases
Talking about Weaknesses	• "One area I am working to improve is..." • "I sometimes struggle with..." • "I have been learning to manage..."
Questions to Ask the Interviewer	• "Can you describe ...?" • "What are the goals for the team in the next year?" • "How do you measure success for this position?"
Discussing Salary Expectations	• "Based on my experience, I expect a salary in the range of..." • "What is the salary range for this position?" • "I am flexible and would like to hear about your compensation package."



Practice

A. Rewrite: Talk about your weaknesses

Instructions: Rewrite these weak answers in a more positive and professional way. Be honest, but show how you are improving or how you manage the issue.

1. **Answer: “I don’t work well with others.”**
Improved:
2. **Answer: “I can’t work under pressure.”**
Improved:
3. **Answer: “I’m bad at public speaking.”**
Improved:
4. **Answer: “I have no experience.”**
Improved:
5. **Answer: “I’m not good with technology.”**
Improved:



Production

MOCK JOB INTERVIEW

Directions:

- Pair up with a partner.

Step 1: Brainstorm a list of potential interview questions based on the following categories:

- Work experience
- Past projects
- Strengths
- Weaknesses
- Salary expectations

Step 2: Role-play

- One person will be the interviewer, and the other will be the candidate.
- Use the provided key phrases and questions to conduct a mock job interview that includes the above information.
- Switch roles to practice both interviewer and candidate.
- After the role-play, discuss how each of you did. What went well, and what can be improved?

The interviewer should ask a *maximum of three questions* from the list below:

1. What do you know about our company and why do you want to work here?
2. What are your strengths?
3. Why do you want this job?
4. Where do you see yourself in five years?
5. Tell me about a challenge you faced.
6. How do you handle stressful situations or tight deadlines?
7. What are your salary expectations?
8. Do you have any questions for me?

Example Questions for Candidates to Ask:

1. Can you describe the day-to-day responsibilities of this job?
2. What are the main qualities you are looking for in a successful candidate?
3. How do you measure success for this position?
4. What are the goals for the team in the next year?
5. Can you tell me more about the company culture?
6. What opportunities are there for professional development?
7. How does the performance review process work here?
8. What are the next steps in the interview process?

Discussion

1. How can someone get ready for an interview? What can they do to feel less nervous?
2. What are some common mistakes that candidates make in interviews? How can they avoid these mistakes?
3. How has the interview process changed in recent years? What are the good and bad things about online interviews?

Lesson 10

Review and Practice



Warm-up

Answer the following questions:

1. Why is it important to be able to talk about one's past work experience?
2. What are the ways to succeed in job interviews?



Discussion: Review Questions

1. What are common interview questions?
2. How can you talk about past professional experience?
3. What are phrases that you can use to talk about strengths?
4. What phrases can you use to talk about weaknesses?
5. How can you talk about your skills?
6. Why is it important to be able to describe your past projects?
7. Why is it essential to research a company before an interview?
8. How should you discuss salary?
9. What common mistakes should you avoid during an interview?
10. How can you follow up after an interview?



Practice

A. Past work, Challenges, and Skills

Follow the instructions in each number to answer the question

1. Talk about one of your previous jobs.

Start with: **"I used to work as..."** (Name the role and company briefly).

2. What was one main thing you were responsible for?

Use: **"I was responsible for..."** (Keep it concise).

3. What's one thing you gained experience during that job?

Use: **"I gained experience in..."** (Focus on one key skill or area).

4. Briefly mention one task you worked on.

Start with: **"One time, I worked on..."** (Keep it short and simple).

5. Briefly describe a challenge you faced at work.

Start with: **"A challenge I faced was..."** (Focus on one specific challenge and keep the description short).

6. What's one thing you learned or developed from that experience?

Use: **"This project helped me develop..."** or **"I gained experience in..."** (Focus on one key takeaway).

B. Interview Analysis

1. Read the interview together in pairs
2. Identify what the candidate did well and what needs improvement (structure, politeness, examples).
3. Suggest at least two ways the candidate could improve their answers (e.g., add more details, use another key phrase, or ask more questions).

Interviewer: Good morning. Please introduce yourself.

Candidate: Good morning. My name is Maria. I have worked in customer service before and I enjoy talking to people. I'm happy to be here.

Interviewer: Can you tell me about your past work experience?

Candidate: Yes, I worked at a shop for some time. I helped customers and did other things. There were some busy days, and sometimes I had to solve small problems. It was interesting and I learned a lot.

Interviewer: What are your strengths?

Candidate: I think I am friendly and I can work with others. My colleagues said I am helpful. I try to do my best at work.

Interviewer: What about your weaknesses?

Candidate: Sometimes I get a bit nervous when it's very busy. But I try to manage and stay positive.

Interviewer: Why do you want to work with us?

Candidate: I think your company is good and I want to learn more. I live nearby so it's convenient for me.

Interviewer: Do you have any questions for us?

Candidate: Maybe you could tell me about the working hours?

Section	What Was Good?	What Needs Improvement?	Suggestion/Example
Introduction			
Past Work Experience			
Strengths			
Weaknesses/Motivation			
Overall Impression			

Lesson 11

Case Study: Workplace Communication



Warm-Up

Discussion:

1. Why is effective communication crucial in the workplace?
2. Can you think of a situation where poor communication led to a problem at work?
3. How can effective communication improve teamwork and productivity?





Case Study

Study the case-study below and answer the questions

Case Study: Feedback on Performance

Background:

The marketing team at XYZ Corp has recently launched a new campaign. While the campaign received good initial traction, the overall results were below expectations. The team manager, Sarah, needs to have a difficult conversation with one of her team members, Tom, who was responsible for a significant portion of the campaign's content creation.

Situation:

Tom has been a valuable member of the team for the past two years, but Sarah has noticed that his recent work lacks the creativity and attention to detail that he previously demonstrated. In addition, Tom has been showing signs of disengagement during team meetings and often appears distracted.

Objectives of the Conversation:

- Sarah wants to provide constructive feedback to Tom about his recent performance without demotivating him.
- She needs to understand Tom's perspective and any underlying issues that might be affecting his work.
- Sarah hopes to encourage Tom to regain his enthusiasm for the project and to discuss possible solutions to improve his performance.

Case-study Analysis:

1. How should Sarah prepare for the conversation? What points should she consider to ensure the meeting is constructive?
2. How can Sarah ensure that Tom feels comfortable during this difficult conversation?
3. What questions should Sarah ask to understand Tom's situation better? What specific feedback should Sarah provide, and how should she deliver it?
4. How can they collaboratively create an action plan for improvement?

Discussion:

1. What are some common communication barriers in the workplace?
2. How can you ensure clear communication when assigning tasks and deadlines?
3. What strategies can be used to improve team communication?



Production

Activity 1: Role Play: Communication at Workplace

1. Choose a Scenario

- A colleague is often late for meetings.
- A coworker is speaking negatively in front of clients.
- A colleague keeps interrupting during discussions.
- A team member received negative feedback from the other team they are collaborating with.
- A team member often misses messages and responds late.

2. Preparation

- Each student chooses a role (e.g., manager/employee or peer/peer).
- Plan what you will say using **key phrases** from the lesson:
 - ✓ I'd like to share some feedback...
 - ✓ I'm a bit concerned about...
 - ✓ Could we find a way to...
 - ✓ I understand this might be frustrating for you.
 - ✓ Let's stay focused on solutions.
 - ✓ I see your point.

3. Role-Play

- Act out the conversation in pairs, using natural tone, polite language, and appropriate intonation.

Discussion:

- What key phrases did you use during your conversation? Were they effective in keeping the conversation polite and professional? Why or why not?
- How did you handle the other person's feelings or reactions in your conversation? What would you do differently next time to improve the outcome?

Activity 2: Group Case Study Analysis: Communication Issues

Work in pairs or small groups and follow the guidelines:

1. Case Study Analysis:

a. Analyse and identify the communication issues in the cases.

- What were the main communication issues in the case study?
- How did these issues impact the workplace environment?

b. Discuss potential solutions to address these issues.

- What strategies (active listening, clarification, etc.) can be implemented to improve communication?
- How can these strategies be applied in real-life situations?

2. Useful Phrases:

- *"It seems/looks that ..."; "The main issue/ problem was that ..."*
- *"As a result, ..."; "This affected ..."*
- *"I think the leader/the team members should ..."*
- *"It's important to ..."; "It's helpful to ..."*

3. Analysis Result: Present your findings, highlighting the communication issues and proposed solutions.

Case Study:

Case Study 1: A Cross-Department Project

EcoSolutions, a company specializing in sustainable products, is working on a major project involving both the marketing and product design teams. To prepare for a client presentation, the teams must collaborate on the branding and functionality of a new product. Nina, the marketing team leader, assumed the product design team would provide her with finalized specs for promotion materials before the meeting, whereas Alex, the design team leader, thought Nina would coordinate with his team about deadlines directly. As the presentation date approaches, certain promotional materials are unfinished, and both teams are scrambling to align their efforts.

Case Study 2: Performance Review

Jordan, the manager of a small sales team at a regional electronics supplier, holds annual performance reviews for his team to set goals for the upcoming year. During a recent review with Emily, one of the sales representatives, Jordan praised her for achieving the sales targets but suggested she "be more proactive" in managing customer relationships. Emily left the review unsure what "proactive" meant in this context—whether it required more frequent follow-ups, developing new client strategies, or taking on a larger role in sales team leadership. While Jordan assumed his suggestions were clear and actionable, Emily hesitated to ask for clarification during the meeting, fearing it might make her appear unprepared.

Debriefing Questions:

- Have you ever encountered similar communication challenges in your own experiences? If yes, how were they resolved?
- Reflect on the importance of effective communication in the workplace and how it can be improved.

Lesson 12

Case Study: Clarifying Requirement



Warm-Up

Have you ever had a difficult conversation at work? What made it difficult?

- Was it about a mistake?
- Was it with a manager or colleague?
- How did it end?



Role-play

Scenario: *A team working under tight deadlines faces confusion about task assignments and timelines, leading to missed milestones and frustration. The project involves developing a new software application, with intense pressure to meet client expectations.*

Dialogues:

John (Manager): I've noticed some confusion regarding our project deadlines. Let's clarify tasks get on the same page. We can't afford to miss any more milestones.

Alex: I wasn't aware that the deadline for my task was moved up. Can we review the timeline?

Emma: I also had some issues understanding the scope of my task. Can we discuss that as well?

John: Of course. We'll start with Alex tasks and then move on to yours, Emma. Let's address all concerns to avoid further delays.

Noah: I think it would help if we had regular check-ins to track our progress and address any issues early on.

John: Great idea, Noah. We'll schedule weekly check-ins to stay aligned and quickly tackle any problems.

Alex: Thanks for the clarification. I'll make sure to adjust my schedule to meet the new deadline.

Emma: I appreciate the discussion on the scope. I'll get started on my task right away.

Noah: Looking forward to the check-ins. I think they'll really help us stay on track.

John: Excellent. Let's maintain open communication and support each other. Our goal is to deliver a high-quality product on time.

Analysis Questions:

1. What issues are evident in this scenario?
2. How did the manager attempt to resolve the confusion?
3. What could the team members do to improve communication moving forward?



Challenge

CUSTOMER INTERVIEW ROLE-PLAY

Scenario: Mobile App for Local Food Delivery

Context:

A local startup wants to develop a mobile app to help small restaurants and food vendors reach more customers in their city. They have approached your software development team to build this app. However, the initial requirements are quite vague, and your team needs to clarify the customer's needs before starting development.

Initial Customer Requirements:

- The app should allow users to browse local restaurants and food vendors.
- Users should be able to place orders and pay through the app.
- Restaurants need a way to receive and manage orders.
- The app should have a delivery tracking feature.

Instructions

Team A (Project Team)

- You are software developers/designers who need to clarify the requirements.
- Prepare questions about features, goals, challenges, technology preferences, budget, timeline, etc.

Team B (Customer Representatives)

- You are the startup founders who want the app.
- Familiarize yourselves with the initial requirements and think about your business goals, target users, preferences, and constraints.

Role-Play Tasks

Activity 1: Team Preparation

- **Team A:** List your concerns and questions about the app.

Ask open-ended questions such as:

- What specific features do you want for restaurant profiles?
 - How should payment processing work?
 - What is your target user age group?
 - What challenges have you faced with existing food delivery apps?
 - Is there a preferred platform (iOS, Android, both)?
 - What is your estimated budget and timeline?
 - Do you need support for multiple languages?
 - Are there any local regulations or data privacy concerns?
- **Team B:** Prepare detailed answers and clarify which requirements are most important.

Activity 2: Role-Play Meeting

- Conduct a simulated meeting to clarify the requirements based on the scenario.
- Each team presents their questions/answers and discusses possible solutions.
- After the meeting, discuss as a class:
 - What information was gathered?
 - What was unclear?
 - Which interview techniques worked best?

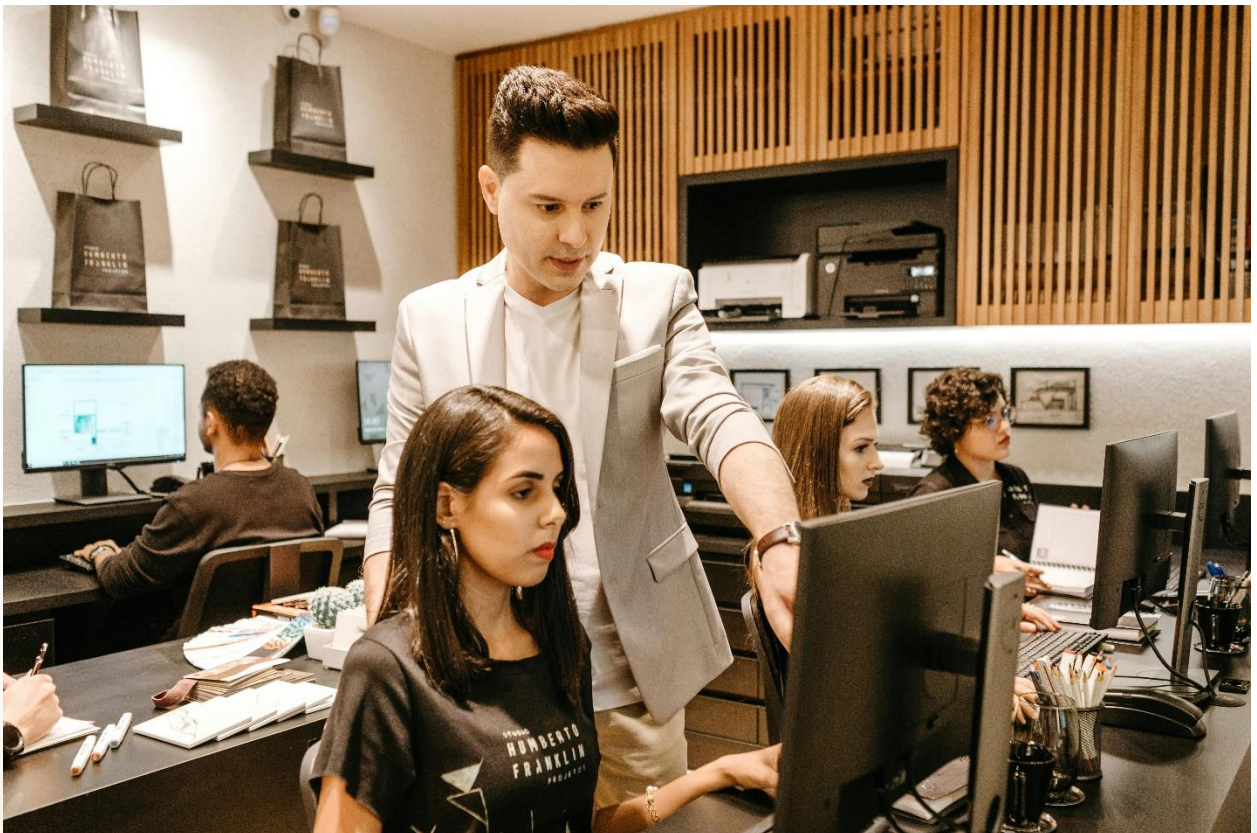
Lesson 13

Case Study: Delegating Tasks



Warm-Up

1. Share an experience when you failed to delegate tasks to others. What happened? How did you solve it?
2. How did you decide who to delegate to, and how did you communicate the tasks and expectations?
3. What challenges did you face, and how did you overcome them?
4. What was the outcome, and what did you learn from the experience?





Case Study

At TechCorp, a software development company, Project Manager Rachel is tasked with delivering a complex software project within a tight deadline. To achieve this, she delegates tasks to her team of developers, designers, and quality assurance specialists. Rachel assigned tasks based on individual strengths. This delegation enables the team to work efficiently, leveraging each member's expertise to meet the project's technical requirements.

However, Rachel's delegation approach has some limitations. She doesn't provide clear instructions on the project's technical specifications, leading to miscommunication and delays. Additionally, she doesn't establish a clear communication plan, resulting in team members working in silos and potential issues unnoticed.

To improve her delegation, Rachel should provide detailed technical briefings, establish regular team meetings and progress updates, and encourage open communication among team members. By doing so, Rachel can ensure that her team delivers a high-quality software product on time, meeting the client's expectations and enhancing TechCorp's reputation.

Case Study Analysis

Answer the following questions:

1. What are the benefits and drawbacks of Rachel's delegation approach?
2. What role does clear communication play in effective task delegation?
3. How can team members contribute to the delegation process to ensure their needs are met?
4. How can project managers balance the need for control with the benefits of delegating tasks to team members?
5. What strategies can be implemented to ensure that team members are working collaboratively and addressing potential issues promptly?



Practice

ACTIVITY 1: FILL IN BLANKS

Instructions: To have effective delegation skills, consider the following tips using the words from the provided list that best fits the context of each sentence.

delegation	priority	updates	responsibility	follow-up
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1. When delegating tasks, it's essential to set a clear _____ level for each task.
2. When delegating, it's essential to clearly define the _____ of each team member.
3. Effective _____ is crucial for successful project management.
4. Regular _____ from team members help ensure everyone is on track.
5. After delegating tasks, it's crucial to _____ with team members to ensure they're completing tasks as expected.

ACTIVITY 2: PRIORITIZING DELEGATED TASKS

Instructions:

1. **Work in pairs.**
2. **Task List:** Rank the following tasks from **most to least important** based on your ideas:
 - A. Prepare a presentation for a client meeting.
 - B. Complete the monthly budget report.
 - C. Respond to urgent emails from team members.
 - D. Organize the team's resources and materials.
 - E. Conduct a performance review with an employee.

3. **Justify Your Ranking:** After ranking, compare your results with your partner and explain your reasoning using key vocabulary (e.g., urgency, impact, accountability).
4. **Reach a Consensus:** Discuss any differences in your rankings and work together to reach a consensus on the final ranking.
5. **Share with the Class:** If time permits, each pair shares their final ranking and reasoning with the class.



Production

To help you feel more confident and prepared when delegating tasks, answer the following scenario-based questions.

1. You need to delegate a task to a team member. Daniel is busy and Kath is available but inexperienced. To whom do you delegate the task?
2. James isn't completing tasks on time. What do you do to address the issue?
3. You need to delegate a critical task, but no team member has the necessary skills. What do you do?
4. You're managing a remote team; how do you ensure effective communication and task completion?
5. You're delegating a task to a new team member. How do you provide support and guidance?

Lesson 14

Case Study: Problem Solving in Teams



Warm-Up

1. What are some common workplace challenges you've faced or observed?
2. How did you or the team address the issue?
3. What solutions or strategies have been implemented to solve the problem?





Case Study

The marketing team at XYZ Corporation faced significant workplace challenges during a major product launch.

Communication breakdowns between team members and departments led to delays and misunderstandings. Additionally, conflicting opinions on the campaign's creative direction caused tension and hindered progress.

To overcome these challenges, the team leader implemented regular team meetings and encouraged open communication. Team members were also empowered to share their ideas and concerns, fostering a collaborative and inclusive environment.

Through these efforts, the team was able to improve communication, resolve conflicts, and deliver a successful campaign. The product launch exceeded sales expectations, and the team received positive feedback from stakeholders.

Case Study Analysis

Answer the following questions:

1. What strategies did the team use to overcome communication breakdowns?
2. How did empowering team members contribute to the team's success?
3. What lessons can be learned from this case study about effective team collaboration and communication?
4. How can teams apply these strategies to their own work environment?



Practice

ACTIVITY 1: REFLECTION ON PAST EXPERIENCES

Instructions:

1. Reflect on a time you faced a problem in a team setting. You should consider:
 - What the problem was
 - How you felt about it
 - What actions you took to address it
 - What the outcome was
2. In **pairs**, share your experiences, focusing on the process of problem-solving you went through.
3. As a class, facilitate a discussion on common themes or strategies that emerged from your experiences.

Discussions:

1. How did collaboration contribute to the team's problem-solving process?
2. What role did brainstorming play in generating potential solutions?



Production

ACTIVITY 1: SCENARIO-BASED SOLUTIONS

To assess problem solving skills, teamwork, and communication in a team setting, read each scenario and answer the questions that follow.

1. Your team is working on a project with a tight deadline. However, one team member is consistently late for meetings and misses important deadlines.
 - How would you address this issue with the team member?
 - What strategies would you use to ensure the team stays on track and meets the deadline?

2. A critical bug is discovered in your team's software product just before launch. The team is under pressure to fix the issue quickly.
 - How would you approach problem solving in this situation?
 - What steps would you take to ensure the bug is fixed and the product launches on time?
3. A team member has different opinions on the project's direction, causing tension among team members.
 - How would you facilitate a discussion to resolve the issue?
 - What strategies would you use to ensure all team members are heard and valued?

ACTIVITY 2: ROLE REVERSAL SIMULATION

Instructions:

- Work in pairs and assign each other the roles for the scenario.
- In your roles, act out the scenario provided for 5 minutes, addressing the problem presented.
- After the first role play, switch roles and act out another scenario for another 5 minutes.
- After completing both rounds, share insights on what you learned from experiencing the different perspectives.

Scenario 1: Team Member Not Meeting Deadlines

- **Project Manager:** You need to address the issue of a team member who consistently misses deadlines, affecting the team's progress.
- **Team Member:** You explain your reasons for the delays and express any personal challenges that may have impacted your work.

Scenario 2: Task Delegation Conflict

- **Project Manager:** You need to delegate responsibilities for an upcoming project. Explain to the team member the importance of their contributions and negotiate how they can manage their workload effectively.

- **Team Member:** You feel overwhelmed by your current tasks and express your concerns about taking on additional responsibilities. Aim to find a solution that allows you to maintain your workload while ensuring the project progresses smoothly.

Debrief

1. Did your approach change when you switched roles? How?
2. What strategies helped you communicate effectively?
3. Was it challenging to argue for the other person's position? Why?
4. How can understanding different roles improve teamwork?
5. What did you learn about collaboration through this exercise?

Lesson 15

Review and Practice



Warm-Up

Talking point

- Discuss your favorite genres, artists, and the role of music in your lives within your pairs/groups.
- Share your opinions and experiences related to music and its impact on mood, productivity, and relaxation.
- After the discussion, a few pairs/groups share their insights and interesting points with the whole class.



Listening

Listen to the talk and answer the questions below.

Questions

1. What task did the speaker's manager ask her to do?
2. What was the speaker unsure about?
3. What did the speaker do to solve the problem?
4. What kind of report did the manager want in the end?
5. How did the manager feel about the speaker's work?



Challenge

DISCUSSION ON WORKING PROCESSES

Scenario

This is your first meeting with the customers.

Your team will introduce its members and discuss how you will work together on the project.

Activity 1: Introducing Team Members

1. Work in pairs or small groups.
2. Prepare short introductions for each team member (use provided profiles if available).
3. Take turns introducing your team members, highlighting their strengths.
4. Listeners may ask questions.
5. Rotate so everyone has a chance to introduce.

Activity 2: Discussing Working Processes

1. Work in pairs or small groups of 3-4 (one acts as customer, others as team).
2. Discuss and decide on:
 - Working platform
 - Informing process
 - Confirming process
 - Report process
 - Meeting schedule
3. Team members present ideas; customer asks questions and gives feedback.
4. Work together to agree on each process.
5. Rotate roles so everyone gets to be the customer.

Suggestions for discussion points:

1. Working Platform:

- Selecting the appropriate software development platform for a specific project.
- Evaluating the advantages and disadvantages of different programming languages (e.g., Java, Python, C++) for a particular task.

2. Informing Process:

- Determining the most effective means of communication for team members (e.g., email, instant messaging, project management tools) to ensure timely and accurate information sharing.
- Establishing a process for notifying stakeholders about project updates, milestones, and changes.

3. Confirming Process:

- Defining the criteria and procedures for confirming completed tasks or deliverables before moving to the next stage.
- Establishing a process for obtaining client or customer approval on project deliverables, such as prototypes or design documents.

4. Report Process:

- Deciding on the frequency and format of status reports to keep stakeholders informed about project progress and potential issues.
- Establishing a process for generating and sharing project metrics and performance indicators to measure project success.

5. Period Meetings:

- Determining the frequency, duration, and agenda for team meetings to discuss project updates, challenges, and collaboration opportunities.
- Deciding on the format and purpose of periodic review meetings with clients or customers to gather feedback and align expectations.

Debrief Questions

1. What was easy or difficult about deciding how your team would work together?
2. How did you feel introducing your team members and discussing your ideas?
3. Which process (informing, confirming, reporting, meetings) do you think is most important for teamwork? Why?
4. Did you learn something new about communicating with customers or teammates?
5. If you could do the activity again, what would you change or do better?

Audio Transcript

Hello everyone. This morning, I want to talk about how important it is to ask questions when you are not sure about your tasks at work. For example, yesterday, my manager asked me to prepare a report about our sales numbers for last month. However, she didn't give me all the details. I wasn't sure if she wanted a summary, a detailed report, or just the main points. So, I decided to ask her for clarification. I said, "Excuse me, could you please tell me what kind of report you need? Do you want just the main sales numbers, or do you need more details?"

She explained that she wanted a summary with the key numbers and a short paragraph about why sales were higher than usual.

After that, I felt much more confident about my task. I finished the report quickly and my manager was happy with my work.

So, if you are not sure about your work, always ask questions. It helps you do your job better and shows your manager that you care about doing things correctly.

Lesson 16

Case Study: Virtual Presentation



Video

YouTube Link:

[How to Deliver a Virtual Presentation - Best Practices and Techniques](#)

Discussion Points:

1. What are the key reasons why delivering effective virtual presentations is vital for businesses and individuals?
2. How does a brief and clear preamble contribute to effective virtual presentations?
3. What type of attire can be distracting or unprofessional in a virtual presentation setting?
4. How can your surroundings impact the effectiveness of your virtual presentation?
5. How can having fun impact your engagement with your virtual audience?



Case Study

David, a marketing manager at XYZ Inc., was tasked with presenting a new product launch to a group of potential clients and partners. He decided to hold a virtual presentation using Zoom, but things didn't go as planned. David's internet connection was slow, causing the presentation to lag and freeze several times. Additionally, his background was noisy, with family members interrupting him during the presentation. David had also not tested the demo beforehand, and it didn't work as expected during the presentation. As a result, the audience became frustrated and disengaged, and the presentation failed to achieve its intended purpose.

Case Study Analysis

1. What were some of the key factors that contributed to the failure of David's virtual presentation?
2. How could David have better prepared for the presentation to avoid these issues?
3. What steps could David have taken to troubleshoot the technical issues during the presentation?
4. How can presenters balance the need for a professional environment with the challenges of presenting from home?
5. What strategies can presenters use to recover from technical issues and re-engage their audience during a virtual presentation?



Practice

Activity 1

Discuss the following questions about virtual presentations in pairs:

1. **What are common challenges of virtual presentations? How to tackle them?**
2. **While preparing a virtual presentation for a culturally diverse audience, which factor is most important to consider?**

Activity 2

Work with your partner, put **gestures** and **facial expressions** and act out the following statements.

- a. *As you know, the project has been a huge success.*
- b. *On the one hand, it's very high quality. But on the other hand, it's expensive.*
- c. *I think we can eliminate Option B straight away.*

- d. *But this isn't about me. It's about you, every one of you here today.*
- e. *So, what's the long-term trend? Frankly, who knows?*
- f. *It just isn't working. And there are two main reasons for this.*
- g. *We're aiming to expand our product range by 25%.*
- h. *So, our goal is to increase productivity whilst cutting back on costs.*
- i. *For us at the moment R&D is a top priority.*
- j. *The whole thing has been a disaster from start to finish.*
- k. *Profits have gone up from six to eight million dollars.*
- l. *Firstly, it's highly effective. Secondly, it's highly efficient. And thirdly, it's high time we did it.*
- m. *And it's powered by the tiniest microchip you've ever seen.*



Production

Scenario-based discussion

To help you feel more confident and prepared when making virtual presentations, answer the following scenario-based questions.

1. You're delivering a virtual presentation, and your internet connection starts to lag. What do you do?
2. Your audience seems disengaged during your virtual presentation. What strategies can you use to re-engage them?
3. You're preparing for a virtual presentation and realize that your audio equipment is not working. What do you do?
4. You've prepared a virtual presentation, but just before you're about to start, you receive new information that requires you to make significant changes to your content. What do you do?
5. You're delivering a virtual presentation to a group of colleagues in a different time zone. You realize that you've rescheduled the presentation for the wrong time, and many attendees won't be able to attend. What do you do?

Lesson 17

Case Study: Cross-cultural Meeting



Warm-Up

Motivation Questions:

- Why is effective communication crucial in cross-cultural meetings?
- Can you think of a situation where cultural differences led to misunderstandings in a meeting?
- How can understanding cultural differences improve teamwork and productivity?





Role-play

Scenario: *A team meeting involving members from two different cultures: a German participant (Anna) and a Japanese participant (Kenji) discussing a project timeline.*

Dialogue:

Anna: Good morning, everyone. I'd like to review the project timeline. I think we need to set clear deadlines to ensure we stay on track.

Kenji: Good morning. I agree that deadlines are important, but I believe we should also consider the need for flexibility in our schedule, especially when dealing with unexpected challenges.

Anna: Flexibility is good, but I think if we don't set firm deadlines now, we might end up missing our final deadlines later.

Kenji: In Japan, we often prefer to create harmony and ensure that everyone is on board. Maybe we can have a checkpoint meeting later in the timeline to reassess our progress.

Anna: That sounds reasonable. But I want to ensure that we all take responsibility for our parts. What do you think about setting milestone deadlines?

Kenji: I see your point. It might be helpful to have both firm milestones and a flexible approach. How about we discuss this with the entire team and reach a consensus?

Role-Play Analysis:

1. What cultural differences did you notice in the dialogue between Anna and Kenji?
2. How did each participant express their ideas about deadlines?
3. What strategies did Kenji use to address Anna's concerns while maintaining harmony?

Discussion

- What are some common communication barriers in cross-cultural meetings?
- How can you ensure clear communication when working with colleagues from different cultural backgrounds?
- What strategies can be used to improve cross-cultural understanding and collaboration?



Production

ACTIVITY 1: DEBATE

Instructions:

- Work in pairs.
- Students choose or the coach assigns each pair questions for discussion / debate.
- Try to support your points with examples or research findings.
- Conclude each topic with a summary of key takeaways and any consensus.

Questions for debate:

1. Should organizations adapt their communication policies to accommodate diverse cultural backgrounds?
2. How should teams address conflicts that arise from cultural misunderstandings? Are there specific strategies that work better in certain cultural contexts?
3. Is adherence to a consensus-based approach more effective than a top-down decision-making style in multicultural teams? Why or why not?
4. How has technology changed the way we navigate cross-cultural communication? Does virtual communication enhance or hinder understanding between different cultures?

5. To what extent should team members be expected to adapt their communication styles to fit the dominant culture of their workplace? Is there a risk of losing authentic expression?
6. Should companies invest more in cultural awareness training for their teams? What benefits could this bring to the organization as a whole?
7. With the increasing globalization of the workforce, what do you think the future holds for cross-cultural teams? What skills will be essential for success in such environments?

ACTIVITY 2: MANAGING COMMUNICATION IN A GLOBAL TEAM

- Work in pairs/groups
- Read the text about the global project team.
- Discuss the communication problem and decide what caused it.
- Talk about whether culture may have played a role, using careful and respectful language.
- Suggest practical, culturally sensitive solutions to improve communication.

Scenario

TechNova is a software company with team members in Europe and Asia working on the same product. The team has a weekly online meeting to discuss progress and possible risks. The project manager often asks, “Does anyone have concerns?” but the meeting usually ends with no comments.

After several weeks, a serious problem appears in the testing phase. Some team members had noticed the issue earlier but did not mention it during the meetings. Later, they explained that they did not want to interrupt, disagree openly, or speak without being directly invited. Others assumed that “no comments” meant everything was fine.

As a result, deadlines were missed and extra work was needed. The team realised that the problem was not technical, but related to communication styles. Different expectations about speaking up, giving feedback, and showing agreement had affected how people behaved in meetings.

The company now wants to improve communication so that everyone feels comfortable sharing concerns and ideas.

Task 1: Understanding the Problem

Discuss and agree on your answers.

1. What was the main communication problem in the team?
2. Why were some issues not raised during the meetings?
3. What assumptions did the project manager and other team members make?

Task 2: Culture & Communication

Discuss carefully. Avoid stereotypes.

4. Do you think **working culture or communication style** played a role? Why or why not?
5. Is this problem only about “culture,” or could there be other reasons (e.g. personality, meeting structure, leadership style)?
6. Have you seen or experienced a similar situation at work?

Tip:

Use **soft language**: *may, might, tend to, in some contexts, in certain teams*.

Task 3: Solutions - Culturally Sensitive Actions

Suggest **practical and respectful solutions**.

Choose at least **three** and explain how they help:

- Changing how questions are asked in meetings
- Using written follow-ups (chat, shared documents, anonymous forms)
- Giving clear roles (e.g. “risk checker,” “feedback round”)
- Training on meeting participation expectations
- Creating smaller discussion groups before the main meeting

Lesson 18

Case Study: Customer Feedback



Warm-Up

- What is the worst customer service experience you have heard of?
- Why do you think customers make complaints?



Case-study

CASE STUDY 1:

Situation: *A customer named Maria calls Tech Solutions because her internet connection has been down for several hours.*

Maria: Hi, my internet is out, and it's been down for a few hours. I need it for an important meeting.

John (Customer Service Rep): I'm sorry for the inconvenience, Maria. Let me check your account and see what's happening. Could you please provide your account number?

Maria: Sure, it's 12345.

John: Thank you! I see there's an outage in your area. It should be resolved within the next hour.

Maria: Okay, but I really need it for my meeting.

John: I understand. I can escalate this and provide you with a mobile hotspot until the service is restored.

Maria: That would be great! Thank you!

John: You are welcome! I'll send you the details and follow up in about an hour.

Analysis Questions:

1. What steps did the customer service representative take to address Maria's issue?
2. How did John demonstrate empathy towards Maria's situation?
3. What was the solution provided to ensure Maria could continue with her meeting?
4. How did the follow-up offer enhance Maria's experience?

CASE STUDY 2:

Situation: *A customer named David calls SmartTech regarding a defective smartphone he purchased.*

David: Hi, my smartphone won't turn on. I'd like to return it.

Sam (Customer Service Rep): You need to send it back, but you'll have to pay for shipping.

David: But it's defective. Shouldn't that be covered?

Sam: That's company policy. If you want a refund, you have to pay the shipping.

David: This is frustrating! I just want to return a faulty product.

Sam: Sorry, but there's nothing I can do. If you want help, you can find our return policy on the website.

David: This is unacceptable.

Sam: That's our policy. Sorry.

Analysis Questions:

1. What issues did David face when trying to return his smartphone?
2. How did the customer service representative fail to meet David's needs?
3. What could the company have done to improve this interaction?
4. What policies negatively impacted David's experience?

Discussion

- How important is empathy in customer service, and how can it be demonstrated?
- What strategies can companies implement to prevent negative customer experiences?
- How can feedback from customers be used to improve service quality?
- In what ways can technology enhance or hinder customer service?



Practice

QUICK ROLE-PLAY

You will work in pairs to:

1. Choose or create a complaint situation:

- Late delivery
- Damaged product
- Wrong order
- Poor customer service
- Product not working after purchase

2. Plan a short dialogue (6-8 exchanges between customer and customer service).

3. Use the following flow for your conversation:

CUSTOMER SERVICE role	CUSTOMER role
1. Greet the customer	1. Raise the problem
2. Listen to the problem	2. Explain the problem clearly
3. Show understanding	3. Give details (what happened, when, how it affected you)
4. Offer a solution	4. Ask for help politely
5. Close the conversation politely	5. Respond naturally to the solutions offered

Example Conversation

Customer: Hello, I ordered a chair from your website, but it arrived broken.

Customer Service: I'm very sorry to hear that. Let me see how I can help you. Could you please send us a photo of the damage?

Customer: Yes, I can send a picture right now.

Customer Service: Thank you. After we receive it, we can send you a replacement or offer you a full refund.

Customer: I would like a replacement, please.

Customer Service: Of course. We will send it today with express delivery. Thank you for your patience.

Discussion

- What was the most effective way you heard someone handle a complaint during the role-plays? Why was it effective?
- Which polite phrases or strategies do you think are most important when talking to an unhappy customer?



Production

NEW FEATURE INTRODUCTION

Your team has just released a new feature of the software. Today, you will have a demo meeting for the new feature. Your goal is to **introduce the features professionally**, **handle customer questions**, and **respond to feedback effectively**, just like in a real client meeting.

Requirement:

- **Team A - Team members:** present the feature and make a demo for the feature
- **Team B - Customers:** give feedback, ask and answer about the new feature

Team A: Presenters (Software Team)

- Prepare a short presentation and live demo of your new feature (3-5 minutes).
- Explain what the feature does, its benefits, and how it solves customer problems.
- After the demo, listen carefully to feedback and questions from Team B.
- Respond politely, answer questions, and address any concerns.

Team B: Customers

- Listen to Team A's presentation and demo.
- Give feedback on what you like or dislike about the feature.
- Ask questions about how the feature works, its advantages, or possible problems.
- Express any concerns or suggestions for improvement.

Debrief questions

1. What part of your presentation or demo went well, and why?
2. Which customer question or feedback was the most challenging to handle?
3. How effectively did you communicate the main value of the feature?
4. As a customer, what information did you still need or want to know?
5. What would you improve next time when presenting or responding to feedback?

Category	Suggested Phrases
Introduction of Team Member Position	- Good morning/afternoon everyone, I'm [Name], a [Position/Role] within the FPT Software team. - My responsibilities include [Brief description of responsibilities], and I'm excited to share with you the latest addition to our software.
Feature Information	- I'm excited to share with you a game-changing feature called [Feature name], which addresses the need for [Brief description of problem solved]. - Allow me to present [Feature name], a cutting-edge addition to our software designed to [Brief description of feature purpose].
Highlighting Benefits	- With [Feature name], users can expect increased efficiency by [Brief description of benefit]. - One of the key advantages of [Feature name] is...
Engaging the Audience	- Let's take a closer look at [Feature name] together and discuss how it aligns with your organization's objectives. - If you have any questions about [Feature name], feel free to ask.
Closing Statement	- I appreciate the opportunity to introduce [Feature name] to you today. If you'd like to learn more or schedule a demo, please don't hesitate to reach out to me. - Thank you for your attention. We're confident that [Feature name] will make a significant impact on your operations, and we look forward to your continued partnership.

Lesson 19

Case Study: Negotiation



Warm-Up

1. Share an example of a successful negotiation you've been a part of, and what tactics were used to achieve a positive outcome.
2. How do you determine your walk-away point in a negotiation, and what factors influence this decision?





Case Study: Negotiating a Service Contract

Background

BrightTech Solutions is a small IT service company that provides cloud storage and data backup for businesses. A growing retail company, **ShopLine**, wants to sign a service contract with BrightTech to store its customer and sales data. Both companies see this as a good opportunity to work together, but during the negotiation, several problems appear.

The Negotiation Issues

1. **Price:** BrightTech offers a yearly contract for **\$25,000**, but ShopLine says its budget is only **\$18,000**. ShopLine asks for a discount, but BrightTech says the price is already competitive.
2. **Storage Capacity:** ShopLine wants **unlimited storage**, because its customer data grows quickly. BrightTech, however, offers only **2 TB**. More storage is available, but with an extra fee.
3. **Support Services:** ShopLine requests **24/7 customer support** and help with system setup. BrightTech can provide 24/7 support, but only for premium customers. Standard customers get support only during working hours.

Because of these differences, the negotiation becomes difficult. Both sides want to reach an agreement, but neither wants to lose important terms.

Case Study Analysis

1. What are the three main issues in the negotiation?
2. What does each company want? Why?
3. Which points do you think are most difficult to agree on? Why?
4. How could BrightTech and ShopLine find a middle solution on: price - storage capacity - support services
5. If you were the negotiator for BrightTech, what would you offer to keep the customer?
6. If you were ShopLine, what would you be flexible about?



Practice

Answer the following scenario-based questions in pairs.

Scenario 1: Contract Negotiations

You are a sales representative for a software company, you are negotiating a contract with a potential client, the client is interested in purchasing your software but is concerned about the cost. What do you do?

Questions:

1. How do you address the client's concerns about the cost?
2. What negotiation strategies do you use to try to close a deal?
3. What are the key benefits of your software that you highlight during the negotiation?

Scenario 2: Salary Negotiation

You are negotiating your salary with a potential employer. They initially offer less than what you expected.

Questions:

1. How do you address the employer's offer?
2. What justifications do you provide to negotiate for a higher salary?
3. How do you highlight your qualifications and experience during the negotiation?

Scenario 3: Project Scope Negotiation

You are the project manager negotiating the scope of work with a client who wants to add more features than originally planned.

Questions:

1. How do you handle the request for additional features?
2. What alternatives do you propose to keep the project on budget and on schedule?
3. How do you communicate the impact of these changes on the project timeline?



Challenge

SLA DISCUSSION BETWEEN FSOFTE AND CLIENT

1. **Form two teams:** FSOFTE and SummitTech.
2. **Review your team's profile and goals.** Decide your priorities, acceptable compromises, and "deal breakers."
3. **Take turns presenting your positions** on each SLA point. Use polite negotiation language (e.g., "We'd prefer...", "Would it be possible to...?", "Our main concern is...").
4. **Listen actively** to the other team, ask for clarification, and suggest solutions or compromises.
5. **Aim to reach agreement** on as many points as possible.
6. **Summarize the agreements** at the end, and decide on the next steps.

Profiles

Team 1: FSOFTE (IT Vendor)

- **Role:** Provider of software maintenance and support.
- **Goal:** Secure a profitable contract with manageable obligations and clear scope.
- **Concerns:** Avoiding overly strict penalties, ensuring realistic response times, clear limits on support hours.

Team 2: SummitTech (Client)

- **Role:** Client company relying on FSOFTE for critical software support.
- **Goal:** Obtain high-quality, reliable, and responsive IT support at a fair price.
- **Concerns:** Fast response and resolution times, clear escalation process, cost transparency.

Flow for Roles

Step 1: Preparation (5-10 mins)

Each team reviews its goals, acceptable compromises, and “red lines” (non-negotiables).

Step 2: Opening the Meeting

One person from each team introduces their group and states their main objectives.

Step 3: Issue-by-Issue Negotiation

- Start with Response Time. Client presents their expectation; FSOF responds with their offer. Discuss and try to reach a compromise.
- Move to each SLA point (Resolution Time, Support Hours, Penalties, Monthly Fee) in the same way.
- Teams may suggest alternatives (e.g., higher fee for 24/7 support).

Step 4: Summarize Agreements

Both teams review the points agreed upon and note any unresolved issues.

Step 5: Closing

Agree on next steps (e.g., draft agreement, further discussion).

SLA Details to Negotiate

SLA Item	FSOF proposal	Client requests
Response Time	8 working hours	4 working hours
Resolution Time	3 working days	1 working day
Support Hour	9:00–18:00, Monday–Friday	24/7 support
Penalty for Delays	3% discount on monthly fee per delay	10% discount per delay
Monthly Fee	\$6,000/month	\$4,000/month

Lesson 20

Final Review



Discussion

1. What words or phrases do you use to sound polite in emails?
2. How do you give updates about your work?
3. Have you ever had to apologize to a colleague or manager?
4. What's the purpose of a meeting agenda?
5. Have you ever worked with a cross-functional team?
6. What do people negotiate at work?
7. What happens when someone doesn't understand their task?
8. Do you prefer solving problems alone or with others?
9. During a virtual presentation, technical issues arise. How would you handle the situation?
10. A client wants a significant discount on your product. How would you negotiate while maintaining profit margins?
11. You're managing a team with diverse skill sets. How would you delegate tasks effectively?
12. Your team is facing a critical issue that affects the project timeline. How would you facilitate a collaborative problem-solving process?
13. You're presenting a new project plan to a remote team via video conference. How would you ensure engagement and clarity?
14. You're negotiating a partnership agreement. What key terms would you prioritize?
15. A team member is struggling with their assigned task. How would you provide support?



Case-study

PROJECT SETBACK IN SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT

Background: Tech Solutions Inc. is a software development company working on a new application intended to streamline project management for small businesses. The project started positively, but two months in, the team begins to face significant challenges that threaten the launch timeline.

Current Situation: The development team has encountered multiple technical issues, including integration problems with third-party software and unexpected delays in feature implementation. Additionally, team morale has decreased as members are frustrated with the ongoing issues and experience communication breakdowns during team meetings. The project manager, Laura, must address these challenges and bring the project back on track.

Case-study Analysis

1. What are the main challenges impacting the project?
2. How can Laura improve communication among team members?
3. What steps can be taken to address the integration issues?
4. What strategies can be implemented to enhance team motivation and productivity?
5. What measures can be adopted to prevent similar setbacks in future projects?



Practice

A. Sort the following words into correct categories. (Each key word has one synonym and one antonym.)

Isolation Partnership Conflict Evaluation Settlement
 Agreement Compromise Dialogue Dispute Approach
 Misunderstanding Randomness Communication Consensus Neglect

Key Word	Synonym	Antonym
Collaboration		
Negotiation		
Feedback		
Strategy		
Resolution		
Consensus		
Communication		



Challenge

CASE STUDY: CHAIR A MEETING

Work in pairs or small groups, read each scenario and offer solutions.

Scenario 1:

During your presentation in a monthly meeting, you noticed that one member sitting behind the table is constantly checking his mobile phone every minute, making you get distracted by the sound his phone creates.

Analysis Questions:

- *How would you catch his attention and bring him back to the focus of your presentation?*
- *What strategies would you use to ensure that he stops and gets his focus back to the meeting table?*

Scenario 2:

During the feedback session of your monthly meeting, you noticed that one staff member felt offended by your suggestion and was very vocal to disagree with you, creating an intense argument between another member.

Analysis Questions:

- *How would you catch his attention and pacify this heated situation?*
- *What strategies would you use to make him realize the importance of giving feedback about his work progress?*

Discussion:

1. Looking back at both scenarios, what personal strengths and weaknesses did you notice in your response strategies?
2. What would you do differently if you encountered these situations in real life?